power to hand over territory to India after a referendum, he chose to annex Goa by force against the objections of the colonial power, Portugal.

For Nehru, such inconsistency was a necessary function of statecraft. France was willing to return its Indian possessions to an independent India whereas Portugal was not. The annexation of Goa reflected India's concern that Portugal would delay giving up its sovereignty interminably. Waiting and negotiating were better options in case of a liberal France while force was the only course in dealing with an intransigent Portugal. Nehru had already stated in a speech on 8 March 1948 in the Constituent Assembly: 'I can quite conceive of our siding with even an imperial power. I do not mind saying that in a certain set of circumstances that may be the lesser of the two evils.'[13]



Any study of the influence of ancient Indian thought and practice on modern India must start with Kautilya. Also known as Chanakya, Kautilya (c. 370–283 BC), was a philosopher who served as adviser to Chandragupta Maurya, the founder of the Mauryan Empire, the first of India's dynasties to hold sway over large parts of the subcontinent. A lot has been written on the influence of Kautilya on India's strategic thinking. His magnum opus, the *Arthashastra* (the craft of politics and economics) espouses his famous 'mandala' theory – the idea that the king or state (*vijigishu*) seeking extended influence by becoming universal monarch (*chakravartin*) must view himself as being at the heart of a series of concentric circles (mandalas). The *Arthashastra* is spread over fifteen books, totalling 150 chapters and covers all subjects from political philosophy and theory to public administration, diplomacy, foreign policy and intelligence gathering.

Like Machiavelli's *Prince*, Kautilya's treatise addresses a king who is desirous of effectively managing an empire. The book lays out the world as Kautilya sees it, pointing out challenges and opportunities for the king. Like